Spring 2008

The Mountainside

Volume XII Issue 2

Meet the New Board/Thanks To The Old Board

Outgoing President Jim



Thompson turns over the gavel to incoming President Gordon Cloney.



Jackson Bain, new board member, becomes our new Vice-President, replacing Carroll Yingling.

Other new board members are.

Arnold Weinberg, below,





Ron Wohl, above right, and Bob Borchers, below.



We wish to thank our outgoing board members,

Cindy Van Meter, below left, and Hallie Kerr.



Hallie will continue to serve the community as social and security chairperson.



We wish to thank our outgoing board members for their many hours of volunteer efforts. Your commitment to CMA has certainly improved the quality of life on the mountainside.

We congratulate our new board members. They face many challenges, two being the development of Coolfont Resort and our aging infrastructure.

Farewell

By Jim Thompson

Nancy and I are about to undertake our third phase of retirement. The first and second phases were me and then Nancy retiring from Federal Service in 2005 and 2006 respectively. The third phase will be heading south this May to spend summers in the North Carolina mountains south of Asheville and winters at The Villages in Florida. We have had a creative architect and very special builder who are finishing up our beautiful home overlooking the Blue Ridge Parkway. We will be in the Connestee Falls community in North Carolina which reminds us very much of CMA only about ten times the numbers of homes and acreage.



The nearest town is Brevard which is a larger version of Berkeley Springs with artists, a small college,

(continued on page 4)

Calendar of Events

May 17

10 a.m. Board Meeting

CMA Office

11 a.m. Pool Clean-up Day

6:30 p.m. Potluck Dinner

~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~

May 24-26

Spring Art Tour

Pool Opens

~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~

June 14

10 a.m. Board Meeting

CMA Office

6:30 p.m. New Comers

Potluck Dinner

Place: The Barn

~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~

July 12

10 a.m. Board Meeting

CMA Office

6:30 p.m. Potluck Dinner

~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~



Water, Roads and a Freeman Update By Elmer Broxson

Freeman

On April 18th the CMA was informed by the new owners of the Coolfont Resort, the Carl M. Freeman Cos., that the Resort's sewer plant, which processes the greywater from the seven homes in our D section, will be shut down on July 31, 2008 when the Resort's operating permit expires. We have been aware of this likelihood for about a year and have taken steps to prepare for it. Last November we asked our engineer, Mr. Larry Riggleman (who was recommended to us by the WV Rural Water Association (WVRWA) of which we are a longtime member), to recommend the best solution. After two site visits over the winter he proposed that we pump the greywater up to the nearest sewer line of our central system-between the tennis courts and the B-1 lot. On March 8th the Board accepted his proposal. The work will begin after the WV Health Department approves the Larry's plans—which we expect by mid-June. Completion of the $35,000 project should be by mid-July at the latest.

Water Leaks



Working to keep our mountainside pristine

Last Thanksgiving Weekend the CMA experienced a serious water outage in our South System which serves the most homes but has less well output than the North. Despite this our engineer said our problem was not output but leaks in the inferior water lines we took over from the developer. We again sought help from the WVRWA who sent on two occasions a water leak specialist, Mr. Jack McIntosh, with leak -detection devices to assist our site manager, Mr. John Hobday. As a result we have located several isolated leaks and have decided to replace the water lines in the B and J sections. Only time will tell if we have by these efforts got a handle on the problem.

Septic Tanks

As for the septic tank pumping project announced last fall, we have begun in the D Section and will move clockwise around the Association: Sections B, E, T, F, H, G, etc. Either John or I will call you if your tank needs locating and/ or pumping. These services will be performed at the homeowner's expense.

Roads

The weekend of April 19th the D.C. area received about two inches of rain but Coolfont got over 3. Thanks to our regular culvert maintenance program (run by Mr. Terry Miller) we had only 3 culverts blocked, resulting in some gravel road and driveway erosion. Next week we will begin our normal spring road maintenance—adding gravel where needed on our gravel roads and repairing the shoulders of the paved roads with our stock-piled millings. Otherwise all is quiet on the mountainside.

A Mountain Town Where Mineral Waters Flow By Lisa A. Phillips

When Zoe Burger first started spending weekends in Berkeley Springs, she was curious about the legendary healing powers of the warm mineral waters the region is named for. So she headed to Berkeley Springs State Park in the center of town, where public bathhouses offer a good soak for $20. At first, the atmosphere of the bathhouse, more high school gym than luxury spa, put Ms. Burger off. "But after I left," she said, "I felt awesome."

But Ms. Burger has gone on to discover the more enduring attractions of Berkeley Springs: the quiet of the woods, combined with the lively arts and entertainment scene downtown. She has explored diversions as varied as a Celtic music concert and a belly-dancing demonstration. "In one way, it's quiet, and you don't have to do anything," she said. "But there's a lot going on, and if you dig a little bit, you'll find something great to do."

Excerpted from "A Mountain Town Where Mineral Waters Flow" NY Times.com/2008/02/15/travel/

LETTER TO HOMEOWNERS

It has come to our attention that in recent months there have been several break-ins and incidents of vandalism on the Coolfont Mountainside. According to local authorities, this is part of a growing problem in the Eastern Panhandle.

In the case of K-10, G-5, and A-3, targeted items were left unsecured on the deck or near the house. In the case of the most recent break-in at M-5, a large TV was taken.

Our goal is to make our neighbors aware of the situation so that you may take precautions.

Feel free to call me with any questions, concerns, or suggestions.

Hallie Kerr,

Security Committee—304-258-0244



Secure items, such as grills, to deck.

Out and About in Berkeley Springs

By Lois Copeland

The long cold winter is a distant memory and with spring's arrival is the desire to explore our community.

Tony's Butcher Block, is a quintessential neighborhood butcher shop. Tony Guinta, a former meat manager at a supermarket in New Jersey, bought the store while visiting his sister in the area in 2000. He saw an opportunity to own his own business based on his philosophy of "quality and service."



Look for the pig out by 522

Tony only carries Angus 2/3 choice steers. This premium beef has more marbling, which translates to a tender superior tasting meat. The vast majority of the beef our local Food Lion sells is select.

We love the chickens Tony carries. The chickens are raised by the Amish in a natural, free range environment. They look naturally raised and also taste like it, meaty and juicy.

To add to the quality of Tony's meats, he grinds the beef for great tasting ground chuck and his own sausages.

If you don't want to cook, the Butcher Block is the place to go. Tony's prepared foods taste and look like you spent hours in the kitchen. Barbecue spare ribs were his first foray into prepared foods. Now you can find rotisserie chicken, whole and cut-up, pulled pork barbecue, meatballs, sausage and cheese rolls, soups and sandwiches. In addition, you'll find an array of salads, deli, cheese, sauces, homemade cakes, pies and freshly baked French bread and rolls.

Like any upscale butcher shop you'll find gourmet canned soups, sauces, seasonings and fine wines. For you hunters Tony will butcher your deer. Stop by Tony's Butcher Block for a total shopping experience. He's located on Rt. 522 South, 304-258-4770.

Oasis Café, located in the Sage Moon Herb Shop, 51 Independence Street, offers vegetarian, vegan organic cuisine to tempt the hungry, healthy diner. Their menu offers an array of salads and platters, sandwiches, organic pancakes, French toast and organic baked goods.

My friend and I ordered their tabuleh and hummus platter and a falafel pita sandwich. Both were exceptional. Other notable menu items are their confetti quinoa salad and cinnamon raisin French toast.

The utilitarian furnished café opens the side porch when the weather warms. Hanging pots and container plants grace the shabby chic decorated porch. The Oasis Café caters parties, workshops and meetings.304-258-9200

Delectable Mountain Quilt Show, at the Ice House. The always outstanding hand-quilted and machine-quilted pieces are an eclectic mix of traditional, modern and innovative, free-style designs. Quilts range in size from bed-sized quilts to small wall hangings.

The show also includes quilted items such as purses, tote bags, jackets, table runners, dolls, notebook covers and mug holders.

Yard Square Quilt Silent Auction all month around town will benefit Senior Life Services of Morgan County. The quilts made and donated by Guild members, measure a square yard, hang in local businesses. Obtain a map at the Ice House or Acorns and Oaks with photos of the quilts and their location. Take a walking tour through town and bid on your favorite quilt. Bidding only by phone and online. Final bidding **May 26, 4-5pm**.

Art Saturdays, a project of the Morgan Arts Council (MAC) continues through June 28. Guild member Shirley Hilgren is teaching a fabric dying class on May 24 from 10am to 12 noon at the Ice House. For more information or to register call 304-258-2300.

For more things to do and places to go check our website: www.newsite.coolfontmountainside.org

Studio Tour and Art Sale

By Lois Copeland

The annual Berkeley Springs Studio Tour and Art Sale will be held for three days on Saturday, May 24, Sunday, May 25, and Monday, May 26. The studios will be open 10 am to 5 pm each of the three days. The official opening reception will be held at the Berkeley Springs Castle, Friday, May 23 7-9 pm. At the reception visitors can meet the artists in a convivial setting and see examples of their work.

The studio tour is a self-guided event through the studios of the artists in the Berkeley Springs area where their latest creations in ceramics, textiles, glass, metal and painting will be displayed.

Richard Kaufman, a CMA member, is one of the featured artists. Richard's work is well known to many of us on the mountainside. He paints in water colors and inks on imported papers using a blend of East Asian and Western techniques to capture energy and beauty of the natural world.



Mostly Woven, Kim Potter

Richard and his wife, Dilys, invite everyone to visit their home during the weekend of the tour. Obtain a guidebook at local establishments or www.BerkeleySpringsStudioTour.org.

Peter Basquin Concert— May 24

By Martha Ashelman

Peter Basquin will be performing a recital in the Concerts on the Hill series at the Presbyterian Church of Berkeley Springs on the Saturday before Memorial Day. The performance, on May 24, will begin at 8 PM. The Presbyterian church is up the hill from the center of town, across the main street from the Springs.

Peter Basquin has been presenting Memorial Day Concerts in Berkeley Springs for over 35 years. His concerts at the Manor House were always SRO, and he has a loyal following among Coolfont Homeowners. The Coolfont Foundation gave the Yamaha grand piano to the Presbyterian Church to support its Concerts on the Hill series.

Peter Basquin writes, "Instead of "Bach, Beethoven and Brahms" we have Bach, Beethoven and Busoni in the first half of my recital. Ferruccio Busoni's virtuoso arrangement of Bach's magnificent Chaconne for violin solo creates a sonority that evokes Liszt's transcriptions of Bach's organ works. For the second half of my program, I turn to the completely different approaches by the two great French impressionist composers, Debussy and Ravel. I find in all four of these works a great mastery of both pianistic composition and the expressive power of music."



Firewise Day

By Richard Kaufman

The annual Firewise Day event was held just outside the barn on Saturday, April 12. Among those present were Gordon Cloney, Jim Thompson, and Richard Kaufman, members of the Board and a number of residents. The main topic of the day was the concept of survivable space. The idea is to take steps that our homes can survive in the event of a wildfire in the forest around us. This means that we reduce or eliminate all that is combustible around our homes.

In the years that we have been an official firewise community there has been improvement in the reduction of fire hazards among the mountainside homes, new street signs and better driveway access to fire fighting equipment. But a lot more needs to be done. For example, on a drive or walk through the community one can still see firewood on some of the decks, tree limbs extending too close to some of the homes, and dry leaves and weeds around some of the homes.

The next firewise events is scheduled for the weekend of the annual meeting in early October. At this time there will be a demonstration of how to use a fire extinguisher. If you are like me, you have a fire extinguisher, or maybe you don't, and no one has ever actually shown you how to use it. We plan to remedy the situation!


Watch for those tree limbs!

Farewell

(from page 1)

an incredible county library, the Brevard Music Center and of course the world famous white squirrels!

We have had some challenges over the last couple of years with the sale and closing of Coolfont and keeping our CMA infrastructure working. But the strength of the CMA membership and our dedicated volunteers has put us in a stronger position financially, organizationally with our new Covenants and Restrictions going into effect this year and as a more sociable and livable community. It has been a pleasure getting to know all of you!

If you are in the North Carolina or Florida areas please call and stop by. Our new contact information will be on the CMA website. We are planning to attend the CMA Annual Meeting in October and hope to see everyone there! We will truly miss our beautiful view of three states and our wonderful friends in the Coolfont community. We sincerely hope that the future brings a redeveloped Coolfont with an even better environment for Re-Creation.

All the best,

Jim and Nancy

Container Gardening

By Lois Copeland

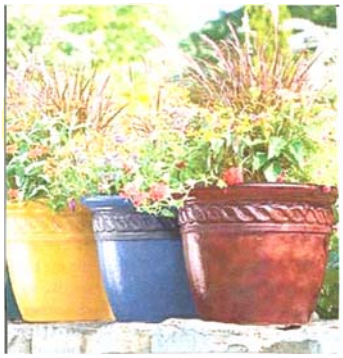
I moved to the mountainside May 2003. The large wrap-around deck screamed for color; my solution, container gardening. Anything planted in the ground can be planted in containers.

That first season I planted whatever attracted my eye, no real forethought or planning. Each year I put more thought into planning the garden. How much sun on the deck, time spent on the mountainside—watering, annuals vs. perennials, herbs, vegetables? Each year with my plan in hand I head to the nursery. Of course every year I fall in love with a few plants not on the list. Yes, they make their way to the wagon and I find a place on the deck for them.

Here are pointers I have learned for a successful container garden.

1. Plan the structure

Beautiful containers contain a combination of a tall, upright plant, one or two broad, mid-height plants and then finish with a trailing plant. (see right picture)



2. Consider growing conditions

Combine plants that have similar sun requirements, moisture requirements, and soil requirements. Your impatiens won't do well in the full sun, whereas your ivy geraniums love the full sun

3. Consider color

Combine complimentary colors such as purple and orange or yellow and blue. Or go for the harmonious color palate; blues and pinks or reds and yellows.

4. Consider self-watering planters or water-holding crystals

Reduces need for frequent watering

In addition to plants, I have had great success and enjoyment planting herbs. Before buying the plants, I think about what herbs I use for cooking. At the end of the season I make pesto with my basil.

I love to sit out on my deck and watch the birds, hummingbirds and butterflies. Birdhouses and birdbaths keep the birds happy. In addition to the hummingbird feeder, the hummingbirds and butterflies seem to hover around these easy to grow flowers; impatiens, petunias, nasturtium (edible), lantana, sedum, columbine, firebush, the butterfly bush and daylilies.

Get those plantings in and let them settle before summer weather hits. Purchase hanging pots and planted containers for instant color at our Farmer's Market.

CMA Magic Meadow Playground Opening

By Peter Corson

The CMA Magic Meadow comes to life this spring with the installation of a children's playground.

The playground will be located in the open meadow to the right of the pool area, behind the CMA meeting room. G.H.S. Excavating has begun grading and seeding the field, installation is scheduled for mid-to-late May. The playground equipment will take up a small portion of the meadow area, leaving much room for other recreational activities such as horseshoes, Frisbee, and kicking a soccer ball around.

The play equipment includes a 55 square foot clubhouse fort, super scoop slide, easy-climb stepladder, triple-wide rock climbing wall with ropes, easy climb, ramp, and 4-station swing beam. For ages 3 to 12.



A fun place for our children and grandchildren!

Thanks to the Capertons for all their hard work in making the playground a reality, and to the CMA Board for approval.

Bridget Borchers CMA Resident Dies

By Bob Borchers

Bridget Hennessy Borchers died in the early morning hours of March 22, 2008 (10/19/1938-3/22/2008). We did not even know she was sick until the end of January, while still on Maui. A seemingly routine biopsy on her back came back as metastatic cancer. She went downhill so very fast. We enrolled her in Hospice March 19. She died three days later.

We met in high school and got married in 1960, soon after she graduated from college with a math degree. Our oldest son was born in 1961, the traditional (for Catholics) 9 months and 9 minutes later. I was still a graduate student at UW-Madison and we were really poor!

All of you remember her as a warm caring person. She never held an outside job, preferring to look after our children and be the most productive volunteer Madison WI ever had. In Madison she chaired the Parks and Planning Commission. She continued her volunteer activities for the remainder of her life, including our wonderful Parish on Maui, which many of you have helped in her name.

She saw all of her children and 4 of her 12 grandchildren in her last days. Our family is deeply appreciative of the number of our Coolfont neighbors who came to her wake and/or funeral.

Coolfont Mountainside Association

www.newsite.coolfontmountainside.org

Lois Copeland, NL Editor
301-530-1115 or 304-258-8127
E-mail: locopeland@aol.com

Gordon Cloney, President
703-467-0611 or 304-258-8098
E-mail: grdnclny@aol.com

Gerald Sophar, long time CMA member, died at 90 December 1, 2007. He led an intriguing and interesting life, serving as an expert witness in deportation cases involving Nazis and Nazi collaborators. Mr. Sophar, an early settler on the mountainside, was very active in the CMA community, especially in the late 1970s and 1980s. An avid tennis player, he played tennis until 3 years ago. Gerald's daughter Siri and her husband John are now full time residents on the mountainside.

Our sympathy to **Ronald and Carol Kershner** on the death of their grandson.

Our get well wishes to **Marlene Weinberg**, we hope to see you soon on the mountainside.

We welcome new residents **Elizabeth Dane and Lesley Foswick**, who recently bought G-5, **Paul and Nancy Lidard**, who recently bought N-6 and **Carol Williams**, who recently purchased P-5



Coolfont Update

By Lois Copeland

Carl M. Freeman Companies, Inc. plans for the development of "The Villages at Coolfont" continues, but at a much slower pace than any of us imagined. The plan includes 1,200 single family, duplex, triplex and condominium homes to be built over the next 10-12 years.

Facilities include a spa, amphitheater, chapel, restaurant, hotel and conference center. Lake Siri will be expanded into two lakes bordering both sides of Cold Run Valley Road.

Plans must be submitted to the state for the building of both water and sewer treatment plants. Once completed the water and sewer system will be owned and operated by the Warm Springs Public Service District.

In March Freeman Company officials submitted petition for a Coolfont Community Enhancement District to the Morgan County Commission.

A community enhancement district is a financing vehicle to fund water and sewer systems and road improvements in a specific community. Property owners are assessed a monthly or annual fee or a one time only special assessment on an initial sale for a home, or both. The assessment fees are paid by the property owners within the borders of the enhancement district.

The Coolfont Community Enhancement District would finance a water and sewer system and road improvements on Cold Run Valley Road.

Coolfont Mountainside Association is not within the borders of the enhancement district. Some residents worry that they will be forced to become part of the Coolfont Community Enhancement District and therefore increasing their water and sewer rates.



The A-frame still stands, though aging and in disrepair!

Once the petition meets the proper requirements the county commission will schedule public hearings. CMA is monitoring the petition process and other concerns regarding the development of Coolfont.

Currently Freeman plans to break ground early 2010.